



IEEE SIGNAL PROCESSING SOCIETY AWARD ENDORSEMENT FORM

Who is Not Eligible to Serve as an Endorser for an IEEE Signal Processing Society Award nominee?

No member of the IEEE Signal Processing Society Awards Board or IEEE Signal Processing Society Board of Governors, for specified awards only. See award descriptions for details. Only individuals are allowed to provide endorsements. Endorsements from boards/committees will not be accepted. Nominations by individuals can be accompanied by up to two endorsements by other individual members. Nominations supported by committees/boards cannot be accompanied by endorsements. Members of a committee/board may participate as individual endorsers for other members of the same board/committee. In addition, a nominator may not serve as an endorser for a nomination he/she is submitting. IEEE staff cannot serve as an endorser.

Who is Eligible to Serve as Endorser for an IEEE Signal Processing Society Award nominee? To be an endorser, there is no requirement for IEEE Signal Processing Society membership. Endorsement forms can be submitted by any individual for an IEEE Signal Processing Society award nomination.

Instructions for Preparing the IEEE Signal Processing Society Award Endorsement Form

An endorsement form is an important contribution to the IEEE Signal Processing Society Awards Board's decision whether to recommend/select a nominee for an IEEE Signal Processing Society Award. Endorsers must cite specific evidence of the uniqueness and impact of the individual's contributions to the Society or the signal processing field or the contributions of the nominated paper. Nonspecific comments, such as this person or work is outstanding, without identifying a substantial contribution to professional knowledge, widely used technologies, or industry processes, products and services, are of no value. Comments about the relative contributions by the nominee to any work attributed to more than the nominee, for example, if the nominee is a co-author of a listed work, are of value.

A nomination for an IEEE Signal Processing Society Award nominee **is limited to two (2) endorsements. If more than two endorsements are submitted, only the first two submitted endorsements will be considered by the IEEE Signal Processing Society Awards Board. Endorsements can only be up to two-pages in length. Endorsements must be submitted on or before the nomination deadline of 1 September.**



IEEE SIGNAL PROCESSING SOCIETY
AWARD ENDORSEMENT FORM

1. NAME OF NOMINEE:	Gupta	Rahul		
	Last Name (Family)	First	Middle	Prefix
2. NOMINATED AWARD:	IEEE Signal Processing Society Industrial Innovation Award			
3. NAME OF NOMINATOR:	Lee	Chi-Chun	Prof.	
	Last Name (Family)	First	Middle	Prefix
4. NAME OF ENDORSER:	Varshney	Kush	R.	Dr.
	Last Name (Family)	First	Middle	Prefix
	IBM Research, Thomas J. Watson Research Center, 1101 Kitchawan Road			
	Organization's Name and Mailing Address			
	Yorktown Heights, NY 10598, USA			
	City State/Province Zip/Postal Code Country			
	Email: krvarshn@us.ibm.com; IEEE Fellow			
	Telephone #/Fax #/E-mail/IEEE Member #			

4. Describe your relationship to the nominee and how you, PERSONALLY, became aware of the importance of his/her extraordinary accomplishment/paper and its impact on society/field. **(not more than 100 words)**

I know Rahul through the trustworthy AI research and industry community. I participated in the Trusted AI symposium he organized in New York, where I saw his ability to convene senior researchers around practical AI safety problems. Rahul and I are also coauthors on the Next-Billion AI Index (nexbax) paper, which studies deployability, governance alignment, and real-world utility of AI systems.

5. On the basis of your personal knowledge of the work of the nominee, please indicate whether or not, in your judgment, the nominee meets the requirements for a Signal Processing Society award. What distinguishes his/her paper or contributions from the norm? If not a paper award, explain from your perspective (not copied from the nomination form), the impact on professional knowledge, widely used technologies, or industry processes, products, and services of at least one outstanding contribution made by the nominee as it pertains to the award. How does the nominee's accomplishment compare with those of past recipients of the award whom you are familiar (not naming individuals)? Has the nominee's contribution made a significant difference to society, and, if so, how? **(not more than 300 words)**

I strongly support Rahul Gupta's nomination for the IEEE SPS Industrial Innovation Award. As a past recipient of this award, I see Rahul's contributions as commensurate with the level of industrial innovation recognized in prior recipients. My perspective is that Rahul represents a particularly difficult form of industrial innovation: he has built Responsible AI capabilities inside high-stakes production environments while continuing to contribute visibly to the research community. From my own experience leading trustworthy AI work in industry, I know how difficult it is to make Responsible AI both scientifically rigorous and operationally relevant; Rahul has done this while maintaining an unusually active publication, patenting, and community-building record. In large industrial AI organizations, production safety work requires coordination across science, engineering, product, policy, legal, and executive decision-making. The work must be technically credible, operationally reliable, and ready to influence real launch decisions. Rahul has done this for Alexa, Amazon Nova, and Amazon AGI initiatives, including safety evaluation, red-teaming, third-party assessment, and release-readiness work for frontier foundation models. His leadership has contributed to safer AI systems at customer scale. What distinguishes Rahul is that he has not allowed production demands to make the work invisible. He has continued to publish, patent, organize workshops, create academic challenges, and support university-facing research programs. I have seen this first-hand through the Trusted AI symposium he organized in New York and through our collaboration on the nexbax paper. Rahul is unusually effective at translating industrial Responsible AI problems into research artifacts and community forums that others can build on. In my judgment, Rahul's impact is important because it shows how Responsible AI can move from aspiration to deployed practice.

6. Provide a brief listing of your own credentials. **(not more than 100 words)**

Kush R. Varshney is an IBM Fellow at IBM Research, Thomas J. Watson Research Center, where he directs Human-Centered Trustworthy AI research. He is an IEEE Fellow, a past recipient of the IEEE SPS Industrial Innovation Award, author of Trustworthy Machine Learning, and has led major trustworthy AI toolkits including AI Fairness 360 and AI Explainability 360.